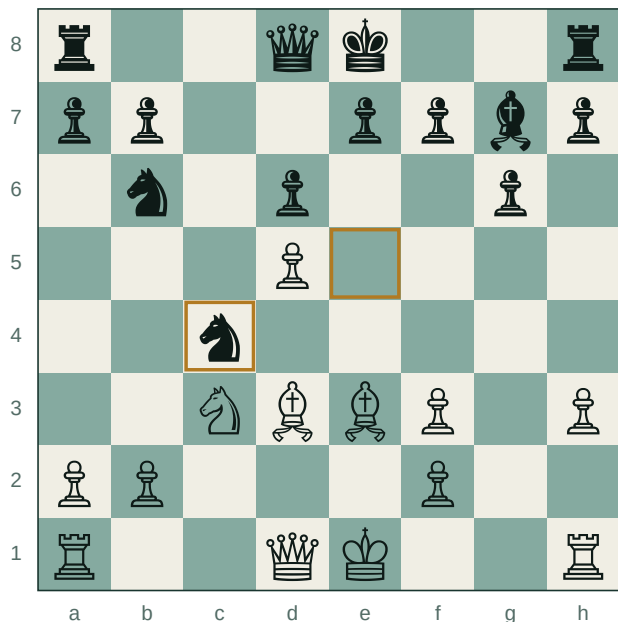


Forks and double attacks: White, move 13

Forks and double attacks

White to move



Previous move: 12...Nxc4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

13. Bxc4 Nxc4 14. Qa4+ Qd7 15. Qxc4

13.Bxc4 The bishop captures the knight on c4. Recorded reply: **13...Nxc4**.

14.Qa4+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. From a4 it attacks king on e8 and knight on c4. Recorded reply: **14...Qd7**.

15.Qxc4 The queen captures the knight on c4.

At the end, nominal material is White 31 / Black 29 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -1 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Two attacked pieces do not guarantee a gain if the forking piece can be captured or one target moves with check.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A fork attacks multiple targets at once. The combination works when the defender cannot save everything or generate a stronger forcing reply.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for checking forks first, then double attacks on queens, rooks, and undefended pieces. Follow the line until the material is actually collected.

The defending king is on e8. Geometrically undefended: bishop on g7. Check for tactical protection.